ANIME DISCOVERY / PERSONAL LIBRARY / WEB APP

AniTAG
Complete Setup Guide

Local run, free public deploy, and the separate API step needed for episode playback.

ANITAG

Premium straw-hat compass mark included as a transparent SVG.

What is included

AniTAG source files, the transparent logo and fallback art, the production build, local library/history storage, and this deployment guide. The production build is a static site and can be uploaded to Cloudflare Pages.

Important: Website files and the episode API are separate deployments. The public site can show discovery, search, library, history, and settings without an API. Episode playback needs an API URL that you operate or are authorized to use.

1. Run AniTAG on your computer

Open PowerShell in the AniTAG folder and run:

```
npm ci
npm run dev
```

Open the local URL printed in the terminal (usually http://localhost:5173). Keep the terminal running while you check the site. Use Ctrl+C in that same terminal to stop it.

For a production build, run:

```
npm run build
```

The deployable site is written to **dist/**. The supplied AniTAG-pages-upload.zip already contains those built files at the ZIP root.

2. Publish the frontend free

Quick manual upload (the included ZIP):

1. Sign in to Cloudflare Dashboard.
2. Open Workers & Pages, choose Create application, then Pages and Direct Upload.
3. Name the project (for example, anitag).
4. Upload **AniTAG-pages-upload.zip** and select Deploy site.
5. Cloudflare gives the site a URL like **https://anitag.pages.dev**. The project name may need a small change if it is already taken.

This manual upload is the shortest path. Later updates require running npm run build again and uploading the new dist output. Cloudflare does not let a Direct Upload project switch to Git integration; create a Git-integrated Pages project instead if you want automatic deploys after every push.

Automatic deploy option: put the source in a GitHub repository, then create a Pages project and connect that repository. Set build command to **npm run build** and output directory to **dist**. Pushes to the production branch trigger a new build.

Domain: the pages.dev address is free. A custom domain such as anitag.com is a separately registered domain and usually costs money. You can connect a domain you already own in Pages > Custom domains.

3. Enable playback with an authorized API

AniTAG reads VITE_STREAM_API_BASE at build time. For a hosted build, point it at a public HTTPS API endpoint that you operate or are authorized to use. Do not use localhost or a private LAN address in a public build.

Create a file named **.env.production** beside package.json with:

```
VITE_STREAM_API_BASE=https://your-authorized-api.example
```

Then run npm run build again and redeploy the new dist output. If the API supports only selected paths or needs CORS, configure it to allow requests from your Pages hostname. Keep private API keys on the server; VITE_ variables are included in browser code and are public.

The current project also contains a separate provider-aggregator API. Its Node server is not included in the static upload, and the player will not work until an authorized API is configured. The supplied static ZIP intentionally does not pretend that localhost:4000 exists in production.

4. Files and troubleshooting

Files supplied

File	Use
AniTAG-pages-upload.zip	Built static site; upload this to Cloudflare Pages Direct Upload.
AniTAG-source-and-deploy.zip	Portable source project; extract, run npm ci, then npm run build.
output/pdf/AniTAG-complete-setup-guide.pdf	This guide.

Quick fixes

Page opens but player says API unavailable: set VITE_STREAM_API_BASE to your authorized API URL, rebuild, and redeploy.
API works locally but not online: verify it has HTTPS and permits browser requests from your Pages URL (CORS).
Blank/old version after redeploy: hard refresh with Ctrl+F5; service worker updates may take a reload.
Cloudflare shows a 404 on the project URL: confirm dist contains index.html at its top level and upload the contents of dist, not the parent project folder.

Speed expectations

Cloudflare distributes static site assets close to visitors. It cannot make AniList metadata requests or an external video stream faster. Playback quality depends on the authorized API, media host, and the viewer network. Cloudflare Workers Free has request and CPU limits, so test API workload and account quotas before relying on it.

Official references

Cloudflare Pages Direct Upload
Cloudflare Pages Git integration
Cloudflare Pages build configuration
Cloudflare Workers limits

AniTAG build checked with npm run build. Guide last updated 13 Oct 2026.